About the author



Robert Frost (1874-1968) was an American poet noted for his realistic descriptions of rural life. Born on 26 March 1874, he spent his first 40 years as an unknown entity. He received four Pulitzer prizes for poetry and was a special guest at President John F. Kennedy's inauguration. Frost became a poetic force and the unofficial Poet Laureate of the United States. Some of his famous works are *The Road Not Taken, West Running Brook, Mending Wall, After Apple Picking etc.*

DO YOU KNOW?

Jawaharlal Nehru, the former Prime Minister of India, had the last two lines of this poem written in block letters and placed it on his desk as these lines reminded him of his responsibilities.

GLOSSARY

queer (adj.) : strange, odd

woods (n) : an area of land covered with a thick growth of trees.

harness (n) : straps and fittings by which a horse is fastened to a cart or carriage

frozen (adj.) : in ice form

sweep (v) : to move swiftly and smoothly

downy (adj.) : soft and fluffy

flake (n) : a small piece of snowflake

A. Memorise the poem 'Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening'.

B. Read the following lines and answer the following questions.

1. *He will not see me stopping here*
   To watch his woods fill up with snow.
   a) Whom does 'he' refer to?
   b) Identify the season in these lines.
2. *My little horse must think it queer*
   To stop without a farmhouse near
   a) Who is the speaker?
   b) Why should the horse think it queer?
   c) Pick out the rhyming words.
3. *He gives his harness bells a shake*
   To ask if there is some mistake.
   a) Whom does 'he' refer to in these lines?
   b) Why does 'he' give his harness bells a shake?
   c) How does the horse communicate with the poet?
4. *The woods are lovely, dark and deep,*
   But I have promises to keep
   a) How are the woods?
   b) Whom does 'I' refer to?
   c) What are the promises the speaker is talking about?

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